Translating

H 2219

A. Background 1
B. Recent revisions 2
C. Definitions 2
D. Translating and interpreting 2
D.1. General 2
D.2. Special languages 2
D.2.a. General 2
D.2.b. Translating into French, [German, etc.] 2
D.3. Disciplines 3
D.4. Sacred works 3
E. Machine translating 3
E.1. General 3
E.2. Special languages 3
F. Translating services 3
F.1. General 3
F.2. Special services 4
F.3. Special fields 4
G. Extended examples 4
Revision history 4

A. Background

The heading ***Translating and interpreting*** and the subdivision ***--Translating*** are assigned to works that discuss the technique of translating from one language to another. The heading ***Machine translating*** and the subdivision ***--Machine translating*** are assigned to works about the process of translating from one language to another by computer. The heading ***Translating services*** and the subdivisions ***--Translating*** and ***--Translating services*** are assigned to works on the services offered by organizations specializing in translating and

interpreting. This instruction sheet provides guidelines for assigning these headings and subdivisions. For guidelines on translations, see H 2220.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Handbooks and manuals***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

B. Recent revisions

2026-02: Updated template. Added alternative instructions for LCGFT implementation.

C. Definitions

Translation: an act, process, or instance of translating, such as a rendering from one language into another[1]; in general, translation applies to written texts and interpretation applies to oral communication.

D. Translating and interpreting

D.1. General

Assign the heading ***Translating and interpreting*** to general works on the methods, tools, etc., used to render texts or oral communication from a language or languages into other languages.

D.2. Special languages

D.2.a. General

Assign the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Translating*** under individual languages and language groups for works on the techniques, tools, etc., of translating texts or oral communication in these languages, for example, ***English language--Translating***.

D.2.b. Translating into French, [German, etc.]

Assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Translating into [name of language]*** under individual languages or language groups for works on methods of translating a language or language group into another specific language. If the work discusses translating in both directions, assign two headings.

Example:

[1] TRANSLATION Definition & Meaning - Merriam-Webster

```
Title: English-German translating.
   650 #0 $a English language $x Translating into German.
   650 #0 $a German language $x Translating into English.
```

D.3. Disciplines

Assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Translating*** under disciplines for works on the techniques, tools, etc., of translating works on these subjects, for example, ***Science--Translating***.

D.4. Sacred works

For instructions on assigning the subdivision ***--Translating*** under sacred works, see H 1300.

E. Machine translating

E.1. General

Assign the heading ***Machine translating*** to general works discussing the process of translating texts from one language to another by computer.

E.2. Special languages

Assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Machine translating*** under individual languages and language groups for works on the technique of translating texts in that language by computer.

If the work discusses methods of machine translating into a specific language, assign a second heading to bring out the language into which materials are being translated.

Example:

```
Title: Some problems in German to English machine translations.
   650 #0 $a German language $x Machine translating.
   650 #0 $a German language $x Translating into English.
```

F. Translating services

F.1. General

Assign the heading ***Translating services*** to general works on organizations that specialize in providing translating and interpreting services.

F.2. Special services

Assign the headings ***Court interpreting and translating***, *** Interpreters for deaf people***, ***Congresses and conventions--Translating services***, ***International agencies--Translating services***, and ***United Nations--Translating services*** to works that discuss these specialized translating and interpreting services.

F.3. Special fields

Assign the free-floating subdivision ***--Translating*** under topical headings to works on organizations that provide translating and interpreting services in specific fields, for example, ***Technology--Translating***.

G. Extended examples

```
Title: Translating a worldview : linguistic worldview in literary
translation.
   650 #0 $a Poetry $x Translating.


Title: Scientific and technical translation.
   650 #0 $a Technology $x Translating.
   650 #0 $a Science $x Translating.


Title: Translating the Bible : the Ethiopic version of the Old
Testament.
   630 00 $a Bible $x Translating.
   630 00 $a Bible. $p Old Testament. $l Ethiopic $x Translating.
   650 #0 $a Ethiopic language $x Translating.
```

Revision history

2026-02: Updated template. Added alternative instructions for LCGFT implementation.